

The boring component that makes exit real

APPLICATIONS

Workflows
no provider keys in code

Assistants
one client library

Agents
model, tool and agent calls

FIRM-CONTROLLED

AI traffic gateway
one point for every model, tool and agent call

routing

fallback

budgets

policy

request log

CONTROLS INVOKED HERE

C2 guardrails

C3 data protection

C4 identity

C6 cost

holds every provider key: a prime target, so it routes and records, and never authors

PROVIDERS

Vendor A model
primary route, approved region

Different vendor
pre-qualified alternative, same region, same regression suite

Tools and agents
exposed per caller



THE SIGNAL
Time to switch: hours
move a route to the pre-qualified alternative by configuration alone; not weeks; drilled at least once a year

RUN IT LIKE PAYMENTS INFRASTRUCTURE
Two independent deployments, fail closed

deployment 1

deployment 2

pinned, signed builds; budgets, guards and fallbacks fail closed

LEADERSHIP MOVE
"Add a provider" is a third-party risk event, not a configuration tweak
UK firms must notify material third-party arrangements before entering them, from 18 March 2027